TA brief · access, kit and safety

For three to four learners: two tray sets of checked blunt bone/rock models or picture cards, two matching fact-card sets, and four individual record sheets with pencils. Four work as two pairs; three as one trio. Rotate explainer, clue-checker and source-checker. Keep one record per learner.

Follow the local risk assessment. Keep blunt models and samples on trays. No tasting, scraping or forced touch. Wash hands after shared kit. Use pictures or adult handling when needed. No water test is needed for the hinge.

BUILD: three to four learners. Use two pairs for four, or one trio for three. In a pair, one explains and one asks for the clue; swap. In a trio, the third checks the source, then rotate all roles. Each learner first chooses privately and keeps their own record. Hear every learner at the hinge. Re-model a shared error, or support an unsure learner while secure learners try a fresh check. Never use a percentage rule.

No cold calling or forced public reading. A learner may pass. Point, sign, speak, draw, type, write, direct an adult or use exact scribing. Read the task exactly when needed. Keep the science challenge and allow planning in any language. EAL is language, not SEN.

Use the least prompt needed, then fade it. Keep prompts separate from the pupil’s response.

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TA brief · prompt ladder and stage handover

1. Point to the relevant place / instruction.

2. Ask one short question: "What is it asking you to find?"

3. Rephrase the instruction in simpler language.

4. Provide a scaffold or limited choice.

5. Model the first step only, then return the task to the pupil.

Arrival: predictable start and private choice. Starter: hear first attempts before answers. I do: point to the model and let the learner track each step. We do: leave the missing step to the learner. Independent: protect an individual first try.

Review and Exit: the adult receives the learner’s own science, names it back and agrees a precise next move. Record the deepest prompt and what was independent. No physical prompting; pass and pause remain available.

Timing: Arrival 5 min, Starter 3 min, I do 5 min, We do 7 min, We do 2 5 min, Independent 8 min, Review 4 min, Exit 3 min. Total 40 minutes. Alternative route views share the same task time.

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